# Screenmate YC application workbook

## Prepare the online application and two separate videos

The product answers are drafted below. Add your founder and business facts, approve the proposed business plans, and record the videos before submitting. Brown text identifies information or decisions that still need you.

## Deadline and application

YC lists the Winter 2027 on-time deadline as November 2, 2026 at 8 p.m. Pacific, or 11 p.m. Eastern. Late applications are still considered. The batch runs January to March in San Francisco. Check the current application page before submitting.

https://www.ycombinator.com/apply

## Complete the package

1. Complete the founder facts and review the application answers. Replace every FOUNDER INPUT marker and confirm or replace every PROPOSED plan.
2. Record a one-minute founder video with all founders speaking on camera. Use the included talking points; speak naturally.
3. Record the separate product narration. The picture edit is ready to receive your own voice. Send the original recording for cleanup and synchronization.
4. Upload both finished videos in the form or through the hosting method it accepts. Test any links while signed out.
5. Paste the answers into the live form, complete conditional fields and founder profiles, check all facts and links, then submit and save the confirmation.

## How to use these documents

The editable Markdown files contain the same preparation material. Screenmate Overview is optional supporting material. The current signed-in form controls exact question wording, limits, and required attachments; it has not been inspected for this package. Nothing has been sent to YC.

## Video scope

The product footage shows a previous execution of the extension on a controlled sample application. It is edited for clarity and is not a timing benchmark, a live employer submission, or proof of current compatibility across application portals.

# Screenmate application answers

Use the answer paragraphs in the matching online fields. Entries marked FOUNDER INPUT require your facts. Entries marked PROPOSED require your decision. Question headings are a preparation map, not a verified copy of the current signed-in form.

## Company name

Screenmate

## Company description in 50 characters or fewer

AI that fills job applications with your approval

## Product description

Screenmate is a Chrome extension that helps job seekers complete applications on employer websites. It reads the form, fills saved details, and drafts written answers using the applicant's background and the job description. It checks whether each change reached the page and shows the user what changed. Questions that need missing personal facts or decisions are handed back to the user. The user reviews the application and submits it themselves.

## Company website and product access

[FOUNDER INPUT: confirm the public website URL you want YC to use. A deployment is configured in the repository, but its availability and reviewer access have not been verified for this submission.]

[FOUNDER INPUT: paste the final product demo URL and the separate founder video URL after uploading.]

The current product uses a private access key and an unpacked Chrome extension. If providing interactive access, give reviewers tested instructions and a suitable access method through the private application field. Do not publish a shared paid-API key in a video or public document.

## Current location and location after YC

[FOUNDER INPUT: current city and country; intended company location after YC; ability to attend the in-person batch in San Francisco.]

## How far along is the product

Screenmate has an implemented Chrome extension and a web workspace for saving a profile and reviewing details extracted from a CV. The extension supports form scanning, saved-detail filling, written-answer generation, verification of field changes, and navigation through supported in-page steps. The repository includes automated regression checks and a recorded demonstration on a controlled sample application. Live-site reliability still needs to be measured across employer forms. Sign-in, CAPTCHAs, file uploads, unsupported controls, and final submission require user involvement.

[FOUNDER INPUT: append the actual launch status, active-user count, paying-customer count, and date of measurement. Do not count test profiles or automated runs as users.]

## How long each founder has worked on this

[FOUNDER INPUT: for each founder, give the start month/year, approximate hours per week, and any full-time start date. Repository commit dates are not a substitute for your work history.]

## Technical work and contributors

[FOUNDER INPUT: identify who built the product, who maintains it, any contractors or non-founder contributors, and the AI coding tools used. State the division of work accurately.]

Technical description if requested: the web workspace and backend use Next.js, React, and TypeScript. The Chrome extension reads form controls and writes values through browser events, then reads them back to check the result. The backend handles policy checks and model requests through OpenRouter; Exa supplies optional company research. Generated answers undergo a separate review against the saved applicant background before automatic filling. This review reduces unsupported claims but does not guarantee factual correctness.

## Why this idea and why you

[FOUNDER INPUT: describe the actual experience that made you build Screenmate. Include a specific repeated problem you encountered, what you tried, and what happened. Do not claim a personal job-search story unless it is yours.]

Product rationale: job applications repeatedly ask for information a candidate already has, then add questions specific to the role. A useful assistant needs to understand both the applicant's background and what the live form is asking. Screenmate brings that context into the page and checks the result of each action.

[FOUNDER INPUT: add concrete evidence of demand: user interviews, observed sessions, repeat use, payment, or a verbatim customer quote with permission.]

## Competitors and the insight behind the product

Alternatives include Simplify, Tsenta, manual entry, and copying answers from a general AI assistant. Simplify already provides autofill and tailored written answers; Tsenta offers broader job-search and application automation. Screenmate focuses on helping a person complete the application they are currently reviewing, with visible changes, checks that values reached the form, and user control over personal decisions and submission. The hypothesis is that accuracy and control matter enough for some applicants to choose this workflow. That preference, and any performance advantage over existing products, still need to be demonstrated with users.

## How the business will make money

PROPOSED answer to approve or replace: Start with a paid subscription for active job seekers who need repeated help with applications and written answers. Test whether users will pay after trying the product on their own applications. Set the price after measuring willingness to pay, repeat use, and the cost of model and research calls. A possible later channel is career-service organizations, but that has not been validated.

[FOUNDER INPUT: replace this proposal with your actual pricing and plans if they exist. State whether anyone has paid.]

## How much the business could make

PROPOSED framework, not a market-size claim: annual revenue depends on the number of paying job seekers, the monthly price, and how many months each person stays subscribed. At an illustrative $15 per paid month and four paid months per year, 100,000 paying people would produce $6 million in annual revenue before refunds and costs. One million would produce $60 million. These are arithmetic scenarios, not a forecast or evidence that those customer counts are reachable. A convincing answer needs your route to those customers and measured paid duration.

[FOUNDER INPUT: choose a defensible price and customer scenario or replace this with your actual business model.]

## How users find the product

[FOUNDER INPUT: give the actual channels, user counts from each, and paid acquisition costs if applicable.]

PROPOSED next experiment: recruit a small group of active job seekers through communities the founder can personally reach. Observe them applying to jobs, fix the most common failures, and measure how many return for another application. Expand through referrals or career-service partnerships only after that workflow is useful. Do not describe this proposed experiment as completed distribution.

## Usage and engagement

[FOUNDER INPUT: number of unique external users; number active during a defined recent period; applications assisted; repeat users; and how those metrics were measured. State explicitly when a metric is not tracked.]

Useful measures to collect: time to complete an application with and without Screenmate, fields needing correction, sessions reaching review, and users returning within seven days. A sample-form recording is not user traction.

## Revenue

[FOUNDER INPUT: answer yes or no; give actual monthly revenue for each period requested by the live form, currency, paying-customer count, and source of revenue. Use zero only where it is true.]

## Previous applications and progress since then

[FOUNDER INPUT: whether you applied before, batch, prior idea, and measurable changes. If never, say so.]

## Accelerator or incubator history

[FOUNDER INPUT: program names, dates, funding, and equity terms; or none if true.]

## Cofounders and team history

[FOUNDER INPUT: founder names, roles, how and when you met, whether you have met in person, and who is full-time. If solo, state that and whether you are seeking a cofounder.]

## Founder accomplishments

[FOUNDER INPUT: one or two specific achievements per founder, including what you personally did and a verifiable result. Also prepare links to projects, profiles, or demos if requested.]

## A time you made an unusual system work in your favor

[FOUNDER INPUT: a real event, your action, and the result. Prepare this only if asked in the current founder profile; do not invent a story.]

## Legal entities and ownership

[FOUNDER INPUT: legal entity names, jurisdictions, incorporation dates, and ownership percentages by founder, employee, and other holder. If not incorporated, say so and give the intended split only if agreed.]

## Investment and fundraising

[FOUNDER INPUT: investment received, investor names, amounts, dates, instruments, terms, and total raised; cash and monthly spending if requested; and any current fundraising discussions. Use the exact figures you can support.]

## Other ideas considered

[FOUNDER INPUT: actual alternatives you considered, or none if true. Do not list invented ideas to fill the field.]

## Why YC and how you heard about it

PROPOSED motivation to adapt: I want help turning the working prototype into a product people use repeatedly and pay for. The immediate priorities are reliable performance on real applications, understanding which job seekers need it most, and finding a repeatable way to reach them.

[FOUNDER INPUT: why YC specifically appeals to you, how you first heard about it, and any person or event that encouraged this application.]

### Longer-term direction if asked

PROPOSED answer to approve: Start with job applications, where saved personal information and role-specific writing meet in one form. If that works, explore other repeated browser workflows that combine stored facts, written responses, and decisions that should remain with the user. Expansion would follow measured user demand.

### AI coding transcript if the form requests one

Use an authentic export of a feature-building session that shows your decisions, implementation, debugging, and validation. Remove secrets and personal data without changing what happened. Do not submit a reconstructed transcript or this application-writing session as evidence of building the product. Confirm that the field appears in your current form before preparing an upload.

# Founder facts needed to finish the application

Reply with short answers. Write none or zero only where accurate.

1. Founder name(s), role(s), email(s), and profile links you want to use.
2. Current city/country, current work or study, and full-time plans if accepted.
3. Solo founder or team; when and how founders met; whether all have met in person.
4. Start date, time commitment, and technical contributions for each founder. Mention contractors and AI tools accurately.
5. The real experience that led to Screenmate, and why you understand this problem.
6. One specific achievement per founder, preferably with a result or link.
7. Launch status; external users; recent active users; repeat users; paying users; revenue by month; and measurement dates.
8. Real feedback or observed user behavior. Indicate whether quoted feedback may be shared.
9. Pricing or intended business model, target customer, actual acquisition channels, and any measured costs.
10. Legal entity, ownership or planned split, investment, cash/spend if requested, and fundraising status.
11. Prior YC applications, accelerator participation, other ideas, and how you heard about YC.
12. Website URL you want to share, reviewer access instructions, and final video links when available.

The demo profile in the code is sample data. It has not been used to infer your legal name, education, location, or employment history.

# Screenmate founder video talking points

Record about one minute with only the founder or founders speaking on camera. YC asks for all founders to appear, and for spontaneous speech from bullet points rather than a recited script. If founders are apart, a recorded video call is acceptable under the published guidance.

## One minute outline

- **0 to 8 seconds:** Your name, your role, and one short factual detail about your background. If there are cofounders, introduce everyone briefly.
- **8 to 20 seconds:** Screenmate helps job seekers fill applications directly on employer websites. It uses their saved background and drafts role-specific answers.
- **20 to 35 seconds:** The real moment or repeated frustration that made you build it. Use your own story. Explain why this problem matters to you.
- **35 to 50 seconds:** What you have built and the strongest true evidence of progress. The extension and profile workspace are implemented. Mention real usage or feedback only if you have it.
- **50 to 60 seconds:** The next problem you are determined to solve: making it reliable on the applications your users actually encounter, and learning who values it enough to keep using it.

## If there are multiple founders

Share the minute. Each person should say something substantive about their role or relevant background. Trim the product explanation to make room. Do not use a synthesized voice or product footage to stand in for a founder.

## Recording

Use a quiet room and face a window or soft light. Put the camera at eye level in landscape orientation. Leave a little space above your head. Speak to one person, not an auditorium. Keep the bullet points beside the camera and explain them in your own words.

Record two or three takes and choose the clearest. A small stumble is fine. Leave two seconds of quiet at the start and end. Upload the original file for trimming and light audio cleanup. No music, stock footage, slides, or elaborate transitions are needed.

Official instructions: https://www.ycombinator.com/video

# Screenmate product demo narration

Record these paragraphs in your own voice for the product walkthrough. This is separate from the one-minute on-camera founder video. The footage will be adjusted to your pace.

Speak conversationally in a quiet room, with your phone about 15 to 20 centimeters from your mouth. Pause between paragraphs. If you stumble, pause and repeat the sentence. Send the original audio or video file without music or a voice filter.

## 1 Introduction

This is Screenmate. It helps you fill out job applications using the background you've already saved. I'll show you the extension working on a sample application.

## 2 Reading the application

When I open the panel, Screenmate reads the fields on the page and works out what's missing. The form stays right here, alongside the assistant.

## 3 Filling saved details

It fills details like your name, location, and education from your profile. After each change, it checks the page to see whether the value actually went through. You can follow what it's doing in the panel.

## 4 Moving through the form

As it moves to the next step, it reads the new fields. For written questions, it uses your background and the role's description to draft an answer. You can review and change that wording.

## 5 Personal decisions

Some questions still need you. Here, saved preferences handle some personal questions, and Screenmate asks for a choice it doesn't have. The person applying stays in control of those decisions.

## 6 Reviewing and submitting

At the end, the application is still yours to review. Screenmate stops before submission. The goal is to save the repeated typing while keeping you involved in the answers that matter.

## Recording files

You can send one continuous recording or six short files named `01-introduction`, `02-reading`, `03-details`, `04-next-step`, `05-decisions`, and `06-review`. A single recording is easiest. Use your normal accent and voice.

The footage shows the extension on a controlled sample form, edited for clarity. It is not a live employer recording or a speed benchmark.

# Evidence and source notes

## Verified product basis

Product descriptions are based on the README, answer-review implementation, extension orchestration, action and navigation code, and demo assets. They establish implemented functionality, not a production success rate.

The source is `demo/screenmate-demo.mp4`: 111.96 seconds, 1440 by 900, silent. Its repository addition is dated September 12, 2026. It shows the extension on `fixtures/workday.html`, a controlled sample for fictional Northwind Dynamics, not Workday's production service. The new edit identifies that context.

The README identifies manual sign-in, CAPTCHAs, uploads, unsupported controls, and final submission. Full page navigation may require another Run. Fixture tests and scanning probes do not prove reliable completion on live employer sites. No measured success rate, cost, time saving, revenue, or interview outcome is claimed.

Sample profile values were not used as founder facts. Founder details, ownership, traction, and plans need confirmation.

## Public requirements checked November 2, 2026

- https://www.ycombinator.com/apply — Winter 2027; January to March in San Francisco; November 2 at 8 p.m. Pacific on-time deadline; late applications considered.
- https://www.ycombinator.com/video — one-minute founder video; founders speaking; all founders included; spontaneous delivery from bullet points; product demo has a separate place.
- https://www.ycombinator.com/howtoapply — clear, specific descriptions of the product and founders; acknowledge obstacles.
- https://www.ycombinator.com/faq — early companies and solo founders can apply; expected full-time commitment if accepted.

The signed-in form was not inspected. Confirm its wording, limits, branches, and attachments. A pitch deck or this PDF is not established as required by these public sources.

## Competitor references

- https://simplify.jobs/copilot — autofill and tailored written answers.
- https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/tsenta — YC-listed company offering job matching and application automation.

These establish competing offerings, not a performance advantage for Screenmate or missing competitor controls.

## Additional preparation reference

https://getplacet.com/guides/yc-application-questions/ is a secondary topic-coverage reference, not an official form.

If asked for a coding transcript, use a real feature-building session. YC discussed this upload in February 2026; check whether your current form includes it: https://www.linkedin.com/posts/y-combinator_we-want-to-see-how-you-build-with-ai-to-activity-7425293407608193025-W3tj